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IMPROVING STUDENTS' ACADEMIC WRITING QUALITY BY USING ICT ONLINE TOOLS

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FOREWORD

Alhamdulillah, all praise be to Allah SWT for all the blessings that He bestowed upon us all. Salawat and greetings may always be poured out to the great Prophet Muhammad. SAW. May we be part of the people who always obey their sunnah, Alhamdulillah, with the permission of Allah SWT. This book, entitled Improving Students' Academic Writing Quality by Using ICT Online Tools, has been completed by authors based on empirical data who have analyzed carefully and in-depth. This book was initiated by the importance of strengthening the use of Information and Communication Technology in helping students improve the quality of their academic writing.

It was found that these students used a range of online resources to improve the quality of their academic writing when it came to the usage of ICT online tools. Internet tools were chosen due to their value in the academic content-producing process. Additionally, students benefit from the online resources they use for academic writing in several ways, especially when it comes to using ICT web resources to enhance the quality of their academic writing.

Curup, May 16, 2025

LIST OF CONTENTS

TITLE PAGE	i
FOREWORD	iii
LIST OF CONTENTS.....	iv

CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION

A. Background	1
B. Research Questions	4
C. Research Objectives	5
D. Research Significances.....	5

CHAPTER 2: LITERATURE REVIEW

A. Academic Writing	6
B. Teaching Academic Writing.....	7
C. The Quality of Academic Writing.....	8
D. ICT in Education	11
E. The Information Technology (IT) Tools for Teaching Writing.....	14
F. Related Findings.....	25

CHAPTER 3: RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

A. Research Design	27
B. Subjects of the Research	28
C. Data Collection Techniques	28
D. Instruments of the Research	29
E. Data Analysis.....	29

CHAPTER 4: FINDINGS AND DISCUSSIONS

A. Finding.....	31
B. Discussion	43

CHAPTER 5: CONCLUSION AND SUGGESTIONS

A. Conclusion	46
B. Suggestions	46
REFERENCES	48

CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION

A. Background

The evaluation of students' writing abilities is influenced by their ability to effectively negotiate meaning in written texts. As a result, there is broad agreement that writing proficiency is a highly prized kind of symbolic capital in all educational environments around the globe. Students' success in elementary and secondary school is greatly influenced by their comprehension of what they read as well as their speaking and listening abilities. However, in higher education, students are required to show that they have mastered the content by producing essays and projects that synthesize what they have read and studied. At the international level, knowledge is typically shown through academic writing in the form of long, complex projects, academic papers, or extended essays.

Academic writing is a new genre in higher education that presents difficulties for students learning the language as a first or second language. However, the procedure is far more difficult for L2 students because English is not their first language. They claim that the challenge is split into two components: first, mastering the appropriate language, and second, assimilating the associated disciplinary practices. Writing in disciplines requires a strong grasp of discipline-specific writing rules and standards in addition to a strong command of the English language in general (Douglas, 2015).

Both scholars and professionals are very interested in the study and application of academic writing in a university setting. Students should be able

to adjust to the specific linguistic requirements of their fields of study once they start college. This entails improving their ability to communicate while also increasing their level of expertise in the area. Academic writing is an endeavor that requires additional improvement, despite the assumption that new students have a strong command of the English language (Bailey, 2019; Coffin & Donohue, 2012; Hood, 2010).

In this way, teaching academic writing in the classroom becomes crucial for helping students comprehend the linguistic conventions and components utilized in certain topic areas. Consequently, a growing number of scholars consider academic writing to be their primary focus in academic contexts (Jones, 2011; Oshima & Hogue, 2006; Zhu, 2004). Because it gives undergraduate students access to the community of practitioners in a specific field of study and plays a significant role in determining their academic and professional success, researchers emphasize the value of teaching academic writing in higher education. Additionally, a significant number of first-year college students understand the importance of developing their writing abilities in order to improve their ability to communicate in an academic setting, succeed academically, and eventually contribute to scholarly publications (Austin, 2002; Hunter et al., 2007; Jones, 2011). Numerous teaching strategies and the integration of technology into academic writing instruction have emerged as a result of the demand for efficient teaching procedures to support the learning of academic discourse.

Because writing tools are helpful for language learners, several academics have examined how students

utilize them and how that has affected their writing. The introduction of computer-based resources has caused the focus to shift from printed dictionaries, which were the main focus of previous research (e.g., Béjoint, 1981), to both electronic dictionaries and corpus interfaces. The concepts of dictionaries and corpora are often treated independently. Dictionary studies occasionally use a comparative approach, contrasting bilingual and monolingual dictionaries (Ng, 2015), online and print dictionaries (Dziemianko, 2010), or dictionary utilization with no dictionary use (Lew, 2016). Additionally, they investigate how using dictionaries affects students' ability to produce and recall particular language phenomena, including definitions, examples, grammatical information, graphical representations, collocations, and the middle construction (Chan, 2012; Liang & Xu, 2017).

One of the most popular ways that students may improve their academic writing abilities is by using an online writing tool (Andersen et al., 2014). This tool may track students' progress and assist them in identifying areas for development by describing online evaluations and offering comments. Additionally, it offers special techniques for enabling students to collaborate on writing projects in an infinite amount of time (Andreasen et al., 2014). There has also been a surge in research on the effectiveness of different online writing tools for training writers for particular goals. The resources may help students with their spelling and grammar, let them brainstorm ideas before writing, help them with the writing process, and let them collaborate on writing assignments. According to research, using online writing

resources helps students write better (Miyazoe & Anderson, 2010).

The variety and characteristics of online ICT tools, as well as technical issues with using various online tools for academic writing, are discussed in this research along with some perspectives on their use in writing classes. Since ICT is increasingly being used for writing and may help students write better, this study offers some perspectives on the use of online tools in academic writing. It is argued that integrating internet communication and information resources into writing instruction will increase students' interest in the subject and enhance their writing skills.

B. Research Questions

This study is aimed at elaborating on the use of online writing tools to improve students' academic writing. Therefore, the research questions are formulated as follows:

1. What ICT online tools are used by students in academic writing?
2. How can ICT online tools improve students' academic writing?

C. Research Objectives

Based on the research questions above, the research objectives of this study were:

1. To find out what ICT online tools are used by students in academic writing.
2. To find out how ICT online tools can improve students' academic writing.

D. Research Significance

The knowledge generated by this study significantly advanced ELT as it provided thorough guidance on how to use ICT online resources to enhance students' academic writing. The study's findings helped English instructors and ELT practitioners by offering knowledge, ideas, and workable methods for handling the usage of ICT web resources in academic writing courses. at the context of teaching English at Islamic higher education institutions, the study's conclusions also impacted decisions made on the development of online courses, textbooks, and curriculum.

CHAPTER 2: LITERATURE REVIEW

A. Academic Writing

Anyone who wants to actively engage in academic communities in higher education is thought to need the capacity to understand and create coherent written texts (Flowerdew, 2013; Flowerdew & Wang, 2015; Motta-Roth, 2009). Undergraduate students must understand the many types of writing, be able to rationally arrange their ideas, and be able to communicate their ideas in a way that complies with the discourse standards of the particular academic community they are a part of. They can only achieve the above-mentioned objectives after that (Flowerdew, 2000; Johns, 2008).

Writing for academic audiences requires careful word choice to explain complex ideas. Writing an academic paper is simply one step in the process; other steps include creating meaning and interacting with others (Byrnes, 2013; Gebhard et al., 2013; Ryshina-Pankova, 2015). Writing school papers is an important part of a student's academic life, especially at the college level. Academic writing is a skill that has to be developed since it influences our ideas, how we present ourselves to others, and how we may effectively and efficiently communicate significant ideas (Johnson, 2016). In conclusion, a student's ability to access, assess, and synthesize the ideas and perspectives of other authors in order to build their academic voice is a critical component in predicting their success in college (Gebhard et al., 2013; Johnson, 2016).

B. Teaching Academic Writing

The literature has addressed academic writing instruction in higher education in great detail (Bailey, 2019; Miyazoe & Anderson, 2010; Wingate, 2012). Research indicates that to assist college students prepare for the demands of several assignment kinds, including case studies, summaries, papers, research reports, essays, and literature reviews, they need to get specific training in academic writing (Cooper & Bikowski, 2007; Hyland, 2015). Students must understand how various writing styles are put together as well as which language elements and discourse structures are appropriate for certain contexts if they are to write successfully in class (Hyland, 2015; Jones, 2011).

According to Raimes and Jerskey (2012), university students must learn about academic genres to be taught writing for academic purposes. This is because developing academic genre awareness helps students identify the purpose and target audience, integrate concepts and sources, and articulate their viewpoint. To properly integrate evidence and support into their writing, undergraduate students also need to understand acknowledgment writing systems, like as quotations, cites, and references (Jordan, 2002).

The function that teachers play in assisting students in improving their writing and overcoming writing problems has been further examined in academic writing research. Despite Spack's (1988) assertion that "English teachers cannot and should not be held accountable for teaching writing in the disciplines" (p. 40), many academics think that language instructors are crucial in assisting students in learning academic writing

and exposing them to academic discourse communities so that they can participate and engage in written communication (Jordan, 2002).

C. The Quality of Academic Writing

When writing academic papers, the following considerations should be made. Academic writing frequently uses abstract and complex vocabulary and follows a structured, formal, and objective format. Academic writing is linked to the writing that researchers and educators undertake for publications and to participate in academic conferences, according to Bailey (2008) and Thaiss and Zawacki (2006).

According to Hedge, one has to develop five academic writing skills (Murray and Christison, 2011). First of all, the students can demonstrate a great degree of organization, which makes it easy to understand the subjects they write about. After that, students show exceptional writing accuracy by closely observing technical phrases to prevent misunderstandings. Third, students need to regulate their language usage as writers to convey information. The author must also be familiar with the terminology used in the field, and students' writing must be able to combine all of these abilities to create a style that is appropriate for the reader and the situation.

Both Richards and Miller (2005) and Jalongo (2022) provide a comprehensive summary of the essential standards of academic writing in education when it comes to establishing an educational writing style. Jalongo advises a writer to consider the following steps:

1. To define specialized terminology and industry jargon, consult the works of well-known experts in the field.
2. Steer clear of obscure language that might turn off members of your target audience.
3. Remove clichés and replace them with your figurative language.
4. To emphasize important ideas and give concepts life, utilize particular facts, analogies, and examples based on your experience.
5. Get rid of double-speak, redundant terminology, and superfluous words.

Richards and Miller (2005) restate several of Jalongo's remarks. They stress the need of carefully examine every word to make sure the language is suitable for the target audience. They emphasize how crucial it is to focus on the intended audience. They contend that the tone of a professor's work should be in line with their desire for it to appear formal and intellectual. Richards and Miller, like Jalongo, stress that academic writing should avoid using cliches and jargon. They also support the use of tangible nouns in writing to aid in the reader's understanding. This is complemented by the notion that non-contributing adjectives and adverbs should be eliminated. They also suggest that the writing follows parallel patterns. The results of this are "fluency and readability". They emphasize the need to avoid gender-biased and sexist terminology in writing. Lastly, Richards and Miller advise against using the passive voice unless required. Dry, scholarly writing is frequently produced using the passive voice (J. C. Richards & Miller, 2006).

Regarding the style of instructional writing, they advise the following:

1. Ensure that each segment flows smoothly into the next by making transitions as smooth as feasible. It is a weak kind of transition to indicate what will be mentioned in the next part or subsection.
2. Explain if you're not sure. Acronyms should be used sparingly and stated from the beginning unless they are commonly used.
3. Don't use the passive voice.
4. Avoid anthropomorphizing (i.e., give human-like characteristics to a non-human form). Your research did not come to any conclusions—you did.
5. Avoid jargon and overuse of words.
6. Use "this" to modify a noun rather than as a stand-alone pronoun. It is often unclear what the antecedent of "this" is.

According to Klingner, Scanlon, and Pressley, the American Psychological Association's publication manual recommends these requirements. As editors, they hope authors focus their efforts on these mistakes, which they say are the most common in instructional writing.

Several works on curriculum, curriculum development, and curriculum leadership have been written by Allan Glatthorn. He has also authored books on dissertations and professional writing. A chapter on academic writing style was included in his book "Writing the Winning Dissertation: A Step-by-Step Guide" (Glatthorn, 1998). Nevertheless, even in this structure, the chapter spends most of its time on creating, organizing, and adhering to criteria for papers. He does, however,

provide wise advice. He stresses that academic writing requires formality, maturity, and clarity in addition to finding a balance between confidence and apprehension. According to him, a writer should also employ simple language and create sophisticated, intelligible phrases that center the core concept. He warns against using the passive voice in his work, just like other authors in his field. Next, he offers the following advice:

1. Make discriminating use of language.
2. Avoid using too many fashionable terms.
3. Avoid using informal language and instead use official expressions.
4. Do not overuse contractions.
5. Adjective nouns should be avoided.
6. Avoid using the words "we" and "our" in general.
7. Stay away from the second person you meet.
8. When referring to guys and females, avoid using sexist masculine pronouns.

D. ICT in Education

Since the advent of technology in the classroom, teaching methods and strategies have rapidly changed. Professors may now more easily prepare their courses using a variety of ICT tools, which improves student learning. Over the past ten years, ICT has significantly impacted education, especially language instruction. It has essentially taken center stage in the classroom when it comes to EFL training. ICT tools include more than just computers; they also include various mobile gadgets. Ghavifekr et al. (2016, p.39) state that "ICT tools refer to the common technology-based tools that are used in schools such as computers, laptops, LCD, digital

photocopy machines, Digital Audio and Video devices, digital camera, scanner, DVD player, and multimedia projector." A wider range of technical tools used to help education and other sectors at the same time are included under the umbrella term of information and communication technology, or ICT for short. Computers, projectors, the internet, and other multimedia tools are vital components of classroom learning at higher education levels (Ghavifekr et al., 2006). According to UNESCO, developing and executing teacher programs that are facilitated by ICT is "the key to fundamental, far-reaching educational changes." According to the ICT research, teachers' excitement for teaching has improved as a result of ICT use, and they have used ICT to adopt several innovative and engaging teaching strategies in their classrooms. According to Glover et al. (2005), ICT has assisted teachers in finding innovative and engaging ways to use technology in the classroom.

The globe has become a global village with the introduction of modern technologies, allowing us to communicate with anybody in the world in a matter of seconds. This innovation makes it possible for us to profit from ongoing research aimed at raising the standard of instruction given to students. There are two important ways that learners may use cutting-edge technology to strengthen their abilities. According to Kent and Facer (2004), student use of technology is most prevalent in the classroom, but at home, learners' engagement with computer activities becomes more limited. ICT is increasingly widely employed in the educational field since it is a powerful tool for educational change, enabling teachers to deliver lectures more effectively and interactively. ICT research has also demonstrated that the

use of ICT improves educational standards and creates a connection between theory and practice, giving students real-world examples to understand a variety of phenomena that would be hard to comprehend without ICT (Lowther et al., 2008; Weert & Tatnall, 2005).

As students participate more actively in ICT classes, the learning process quickens, and professors may more easily help students develop their reasoning and decision-making skills (Lu, Hou, and Huang 2010). A student-centered environment has replaced a teaching-centered one thanks to ICT (Castro Sánchez & Chirino Alemán, 2011). ICT improves educational alternatives and affordances, which benefits both teachers and students. ICT may also be an essential tool that students use to research new subjects, discover fresh ideas, solve difficulties, and generate solutions. ICT facilitates self-directed and student-centered learning (Kovalik et al., 2013). By gathering pertinent information, selecting the best content, and then arranging it under the assignment requirements, students engage in meaningful technology use. According to Castro Sánchez and Chirino Alemán (2011), ICT can assist students in becoming more creative and critical evaluators of their course material. Since ICT enables students to collaborate and exchange ideas at any time, anywhere, it has an impact on communication skills. It helps students evaluate their issues and make sense of their opinions, which enhances their critical thinking abilities. ICT encourages the creation of more complex ideas.

As recommended by a growing body of ICT literature, ICT in education is acknowledged as one of the most powerful and productive fields of research in the future to capitalize on its efficacy in many ways in

education globally. It is clear from the findings of several research that employing ICT-based pedagogies with students has positive effects. When properly integrated, computer-based technology may enhance experiential learning, promote cooperation in groups and pairs, expand global knowledge, give access to genuine resources, and boost engagement.

E. The Information Technology (IT) Tools for Teaching Writing

Semenov (2005) asserts that information technology (IT) is an inherent instrument in education as learning is fundamentally dependent on managing information. Off-computer information processing includes speaking, listening, reading, writing, comforting, assessing, synthesizing, analyzing, solving mathematical problems, and memorizing poetry and state capitals. More significantly, IT may be utilized for various information processing tasks that were previously incidental in traditional classrooms but are now becoming increasingly significant, such project planning or learning new material outside of textbooks.

It seems that digital technology provides a wealth of tools to address issues that arise during teaching and learning activities. By employing them, issues like time, location, interaction, and communication may be lessened. Additionally, the use of digital technology in the classroom can help children improve their language proficiency in speaking, listening, reading, and writing. When it comes to writing, digital technology has helped students become better writers. These include several programs, including QuillBot, Grammarly, Mendeley,

and Turnitin. The following outlines the reasons why these applications help support students' writing assignments:

1. Quillbot

There are still procedures you need to follow when rewording a text, even if you utilize QuillBot as a paraphrasing tool. However, please do not assume that a sentence that you have rewritten using QuillBot is devoid of plagiarism. A few areas will need to be revised and altered. Here are a few techniques for using QuillBot to paraphrase a statement. We advise you to see these procedures as a necessary step on your path to producing creative content.

- Modify some voice segments and the sentence structure of the text.
- It might be beneficial to switch up your phrases by switching from active to passive or passive to active.
- When utilizing uncommon terms, it is preferable to use synonyms.
- Employ clauses: Sentences require both phrases and clauses. Adjust them to prevent plagiarism: Every tip listed above might assist you in avoiding plagiarism problems. They can assist you in producing high-quality material that doesn't appear to have been plagiarized from one or more sources.

a) Writing using QuillBot

To prevent plagiarism, learn how to use QuillBot to rework sentences. However, the

QuillBot tool may be used as swiftly and effectively as feasible. The following instructions will help you get started using QuillBot:

- Launch QuillBot's webpage. Or install the Microsoft Word or browser extension.
- You can paste your content into the empty bar that appears. After pasting the material from your source into the space, select "paraphrase."
- Hold on until the paraphrased text appears in the right-hand bar.
- Using the slider option above the blank fields, change the synonym level in the paraphrased version to make more changes.
- Try paraphrasing in both standard and fluent modes if you're a free member. To see which version works best for you, click on each mode and paraphrase.
- All modes, including standard, fluent, creative, creative+, formal, shorten, and expand, are available to paid users. These modes are capable of producing more polished paraphrases.
- To achieve the finest result that is free of plagiarism, experiment with different settings and make necessary adjustments to your work.

b) More QuillBot Modes allow Flexibility

QuillBot is easy to use and very adaptable. The program gives you the freedom to make original material by allowing the writer to rewrite the content in seven different modes, each of which generates a new version of your text:

- Standard mode: This is the mode for standard rephrasing. Only a small portion of the original material is paraphrased. In general, the context doesn't change.
- Fluency mode: QuillBot enhances the context's fluency and paraphrases it more widely in this mode. Grammar mistakes are also corrected throughout the course.
- Creative mode: This mode is exclusively available for paying users. Without copying the original, it completely rewrites the content using concise language while maintaining the same context. It strives to create original content, but we cannot guarantee correctness.
- Creative+ mode: This mode is comparable to creative mode, but it modifies more elevated portions of the source material and makes an effort to paraphrase it more imaginatively.
- Formal style: Those who like to paraphrase their material more formally should choose this mode. It transforms the majority of everyday passages into works of professional writing.

- Shorten mode: This improves your readability score by condensing and summarizing your phrases.
- Expand mode: To increase the word count, this option elaborates your text and divides a few words into clarifying phrases.

2. Turnitin

a) Information in general

The plagiarism check is a required element of your final assessment and must be completed before submitting your thesis. The check creates a report, which you must send to the Cockpit along with your thesis's final file. The file used for the plagiarism check must match the final thesis exactly. You attest that the two files are identical when you upload (send in) your thesis. Making false statements might lead to fines and other legal repercussions.

b) Results interpretation

The plagiarism detection tool on Turnitin will offer a "Similarity Index." It has to do with the percentage of your material that corresponds to other sources. The percentage value (blue, green, yellow, orange, and red) is linked to color. Please remember that the type of thesis (e.g., experimental investigations vs. thesis in law) greatly influences how beneficial a similarity index is. If you have any doubts or have a high similarity index, you should contact your

supervisor and discuss whether or not you should rewrite your thesis.

c) Tips for Using Turnitin to Improve Your Writing

General advice

- Don't be surprised by the similarity index or color labeling.
- Look into all of the matches Turnitin discovers, even if there are few, and your work has a low similarity value.
- Inquire about the Turnitin report: if you do not understand or accept what it discovers, speak with your tutor about it.
- Utilize all of the academic writing assistance available at QMUL, whether through your department or the Language and Learning Unit. You might also find the online resource Plagiarism and How to Avoid It.

3. Mendeley

Mendeley is a free academic social networking and citation tool.. It lets you gather, organize, save, distribute, and use research papers and articles, as well as create bibliographies in your preferred citation style. It may be used in conjunction with MS Word to add citations as you type and to create a reference list after your paper. It's helpful for academics who manage a lot of journal articles and research papers in their studies, but it's not necessary for smaller projects. Because Mendeley is a free

program, the institution cannot be held liable for any loss of access to references or later monetization of the service by its creators.

a) How does the writer use it?

Mendeley is a Word plug-in that can be used on your PC, on the web, on your phone, or on any other device. It all depends on what you're looking for and how you're going to utilize it.

Web: You may use the web version to save, organize, and annotate full-text PDFs* in your library.

Desktop: If you want to utilize the bibliographical data to cite as you write or build a bibliography, you'll need the desktop version.

App: When you're on the go, the app version is ideal for accessing and viewing PDFs saved in your own "library."

Word plug-in: The Word plug-in allows you to cite as you write using your preferred citation style.

b) Features

- **Cross-Platform:** Windows, Linux, and macOS are just a few of the many operating systems that Mendeley works with. Mendeley is now accessible on mobile devices as an iPad and Android app.
- **Storage:** If the user wants to increase the storage capacity at a minimal cost,

Mendeley can store up to 2GB and make it freely available.

- **Drag and Drop:** Mendeley's new feature is drag and drop, which allows you to add data fast using your current library and store it safely on the Mendeley desktop for later use.
- **Web Importer:** Mendeley facilitates the direct import of documents into Mendeley software from academic databases and the internet. All of the major online browsers, including Firefox, Chrome, Internet Explorer, and Safari, support it.
- **Import:** Mendeley provides the ability to import data from several popular databases. Exporting bibliographic information from the web is simple for users. Numerous websites are supported by it, including Google Scholar, Google Book Search, EBSCO, IEEE, CiteULike, Amazon, Bomed Central, ACM Portal, BioOne, and CiteSeerX. Additionally, users may import data from BibTeX, Zotero, RIS, EndNote, and other programs.
- **Export:** Mendeley can export data in a variety of forms, including RIS, EndNote XML, BibTeX, X1, and X2.
- **Word processing:** It features a plug-in that works with LibreOffice, Open Library, and Microsoft Word. In about one minute, a user may cite the work and export the whole bibliography. When writing an

academic paper, this aspect is crucial for the researcher.

- **Referencing Style:** Mendeley provides over 6,000 reference styles from all of the leading publications. It frequently retrieves citation styles from the citation style library at <http://citationstyles.org> and uses the Citation Style Language (CSL).
- **Reading facilities:** The research papers may be stored, arranged, and sorted by title, year, author, and date added by the researcher. The PDF documents may be read, annotated, tagged, and saved for later use by the researcher. The whole text of the user's library is also available. Both newly added and recently readable materials are shown to a researcher. The Mendeley desktop's saved data may be searched using keywords.
- **Full-text searching:** Mendeley gives users the ability to search full-text. It is simple for users to search a document using keywords, and the results will appear instantly.

c) **How Mendeley helps writers' research work**

Social network: It offers capabilities for social networking. Building a research network with other researchers is made possible via Mendeley. In addition to creating a research interest page and saving it, he or she can also create an online account. Mendeley automatically recommends a few articles and

authors that are relevant to your field of study. A group may be created, maintained, shared, and the previous group list seen by research.

Mendeley has a robust feature that allows users to form private groups and exchange full-text documents with a restricted range of individuals.

Statistics on readership: Mendeley assists the researcher in seeing and connecting the reading article's statistics, as well as the statistics of research publications. Meeting new individuals will be made easier by statistics.

Data sharing tools: Mendeley assists researchers in posting study data online for other researchers to view, read, and reference. It will support the promotion of your study.

Careers: Mendeley allows users to look for positions in the scientific and technology sectors. Mendeley currently has over 17,521 jobs indexed. A research scholar can choose and filter alternatives, such as discipline-wise and location-based searches, to find a job in a variety of ways. By filtering choices, a user may view job openings and set up a job alert service.

Web library: Mendeley facilitates the researcher's access to internet content via a web browser, allowing users to view, contribute, and manage data. However, the Mendeley desktop has to be synchronized regularly. All of the data is accessible to users via a web browser.

Mendeley Web Catalog: This resource lets users search for information submitted by

other Mendeley users and download the complete text if it's accessible.

4. Grammarly

Grammarly is one of the digital technology implementations to assist students' writing. It is a tool used to correct and scan the students' grammar mistakes in their writing. Not only that, but this tool can also check misspelling, punctuation, vocabulary usage, and even plagiarism in the students' writing (Ghufron and Rosyida, 2018). By bringing the students' writing in the form of software, the students can instantly check their grammar or mistakes using this application and then revise it. After receiving the feedback from Grammarly, the students will be able to recognize the mistakes they made, which can be used to improve their writing as well.

Based on Karyuatry, Rizqan, and Daryani's (2018) research, the use of Grammarly as a tool to assist the students' writing also affects the teacher. The teacher admitted that Grammarly is very helpful in giving corrections on students' writing and makes the students very active in participating in the learning process. The use of Grammarly can also help the teacher to give corrections on the student's writing. Furthermore, research conducted by Ghufron and Rosyida (2018) reveals that Grammarly makes a significant contribution to students, such as reducing the errors they make in vocabulary usage, language use, spelling, and punctuation. To sum up, the implementation of Grammarly can also assist the students' writing activity.

F. Related Findings

First, a group of researchers found that information technology-based learning can improve students' English writing abilities. Students are more motivated to study English when they use technology. Students' writing abilities are significantly impacted when information technology, such as PowerPoint software, an LCD screen, and an internet connection, is incorporated into the teaching and learning process. Computers and language-learning software can improve student motivation, achievement, and communication between teachers and students, as well as between students themselves (Lee, 2000).

An Experimental Study in the Second Grade of Senior High revealed that the function of teaching reading skills through paraphrasing and summarizing differed significantly between the experimental and control groups. Although teaching reading by paraphrasing and summarizing proved unsuccessful. The experimental and control classes both had the same score, as can be shown. The writer anticipated that by using this method, the students would become more interested in studying English and enhance their drive to do so (Andreasen et al., 2014).

Another study looked into the use of Edmodo as an online tool in Indonesian EFL writing classes. The study found that Edmodo, as an online tool, greatly improved the students' capacity to write argumentative essays (Cooper & Bikowski, 2007). A study on the use of online tools also proved that in an EFL setting, three online writing tools (forum, blog, and wiki) had a

beneficial impact on students' language learning progress (Lowther et al., 2008).

CHAPTER 3: RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

A. Research Design

A mixed-methods sequential explanatory design was used in this investigation. The mixed-methods sequential explanatory design consists of two distinct stages: the qualitative phase and the quantitative phase. Second in the process, the qualitative (text) data are collected and analyzed to explain or expound on the quantitative results from the first phase (Cohen et al., 2018; Creswell & Poth, 2018; Heigham & Croker, 2009). Creswell (2007). The act of collecting, assessing, and "mixing" qualitative and quantitative research and procedures in a single study to better understand the research issue is known as a mixed-methods research design. By combining these two approaches, the current study was able to better comprehend the research challenge than if it had simply used one. The qualitative method is a method that makes the data into paragraphs or descriptions. Meanwhile, a quantitative method is a method that uses numbers or percentages to represent the data of the study. It means that the mixed method is used when the researcher needs two types of data to answer the research question (Creswell, 2007; Creswell & Poth, 2018; Heigham & Croker, 2009; K. Richards, 2003).

The following justifications served as the foundation for this study's use of mixed methods: First, in order to gain a thorough grasp of the phenomena, the current study used quantitative and qualitative methods. Second, both qualitative and quantitative data were used in this investigation. Third, there were two phases to the

data collection design: gathering quantitative data and gathering qualitative data.

B. Subjects of the Research

Fifty (50) English Study Program students served as the research subjects. Students enrolled in academic writing courses were taken into consideration while choosing the participants. As a result, they were able to offer information pertinent to the study's objective. They were considered to have basic digital literacy abilities because they had also completed introductory ICT courses. The researcher expected that the activities and resources in the study would be suitable for their level of digital literacy and English proficiency. The third factor to be taken into account was the possibility that these student teachers would soon have a good chance to use what they had learned and experienced throughout this program in their classrooms.

C. Data Collection Techniques

Student artifacts, interviews, and questionnaires provided the data for this investigation. To fully comprehend the phenomenon, the researcher used a technique called triangulation of data, which necessitated data from several sources (Yin, 2003). Furthermore, it offered readers a variety of viewpoints on the subjects discussed in this research (Cohen et al., 2007). To meet data triangulation requirements, this study employed three data collection techniques: questionnaires, interviews, and student artifacts. Every method of data collection is important and useful in advancing a unique viewpoint on the topic, and it also makes a substantial contribution to a more complete picture of the scene of

interest. These numerous data sources also enabled the researcher to conduct a comprehensive analysis, which in turn enabled the researcher to structure the study for processes of validation and transferability and to develop a wide range of contextual perspectives on the case.

D. Instruments of the Research

The researchers used three pieces of research equipment. First, online questionnaires were used to collect quantitative data regarding the types of online tools available for academic writing and how they enhance students' academic writing quality. The academic writing rubrics were then used to compare the writing results of the students before and after they used ICT resources for academic writing. Finding out how students feel about using ICT tools for writing is the aim of the interview. A record of pupils' writing skills before and after using ICT is called document observation.

E. Data Analysis

Two methods were employed by the researchers to analyze the data. To display and disseminate the quantitative data collected from the online questionnaire, the researchers employed a descriptive-statistical approach. The qualitative information obtained from observations and interviews was then interactively examined using the Miles et al. (2014) model. This technique focuses on four interrelated components: data collection, data condensation, data presentation, and conclusion drafting. As stated before, the qualitative data was collected through interviews and observations. Grouping the raw material from interviews and observations based on the developing themes helped to

further reduce it. In certain respects, the data coding process is another name for the data condensation process. The researchers also employed an inter-coder reliability technique to identify relevant coded themes. Inter-coder dependability is essential since the researchers collaborate to create fantastic coding, claim O'Connor and Joffe (2020). We, the study's researchers, initially codified the unprocessed qualitative data. Our data codification results were further compared and analyzed with one another in order to choose the most relevant coding findings to be the last themes to be presented. Tables including the results of data codification, data visualizations, interview transcripts, data interpretation, and theoretical and argumentative discussions were then used to present the qualitative data. Ultimately, the data given led to a comprehensive and representative judgment.

CHAPTER 4: FINDINGS AND DISCUSSIONS

A. Findings

1. ICT Online Tools Used by Students in Academic Writing

Students should feel free to refer to any pertinent web resources during the assignment's writing phase. The frequency distribution of students' usage of various search tools, together with the associated 95% CIs, is displayed in Figure 1. About 15% of students used translation software, and about half of all students used some kind of editing tool. Students also used search engines extensively. Nearly 10% of students said they have used a citation management tool like Mendeley or Zotero. In their academic work, students used both bilingual and monolingual dictionaries (8.40% and 4.40%, respectively). At 1%, the bilingual concordancer was the instrument with the lowest utilization rate.

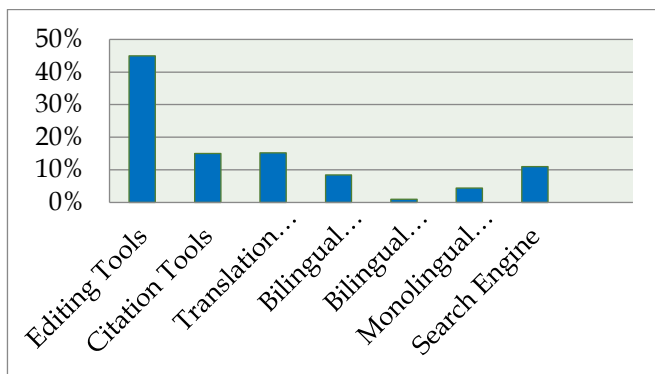


Figure 1. Online tools used by students

Each student uses a vast array of different learning tools. Figure 2 demonstrates that while eight students use five different types of learning resources, six use six, and just two use all seven, the majority of students use one to four different types. One tool type nearly always dominates, as seen by the fact that 78.3% of students who utilize several tool types still rely on multilingual tools for more than half of their searches. All things considered, this illustrates how students prefer to use bilingual tools and how they typically use a limited number of tool types while writing.

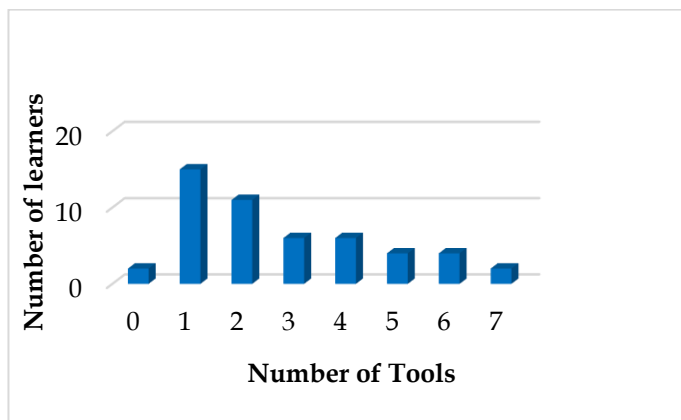


Figure 2. Number of tool types used per number of learners

The data collected during the interview supported the information gathered from the questionnaire. According to the results of the interviews, students use a range of ICT resources when writing academically. Some of the students used editing programs like Grammarly, QuillBot, and Ginger, among others, to revise or reword their work. Another tool that

students typically utilize when doing academic work is the translation tool. They translated sources written in Bahasa Indonesia into English regularly. The interview covered several translation tools, such as Google Translate, DeepL, Bing Translator, and others. The search engine was another piece of technology that students regularly used. More and more students are using search engines like Google, Yahoo, and AOL to find information and resources for their writing. In their studies, the students also used monolingual dictionaries and concordances. The resources that students utilize for academic writing are collected in Table 1.

Table 1
ICT Tools Used by Students

Types of ICT Tools	Names of Application	
Editing Tools	Grammarly Ginger Writer Quillbot	Zoho Writer Language Tool Virtual Writing Tutor
Citation Tools	Mendeley Cite. Zotero. EndNote.	
Translation Tools	Google translate Bing Translator. DeepL Translate	Translated it. Translate.com
Bilingual Dictionary	DeepL. Google Translate. WordReference.	Linguee. Reverso.
Bilingual Concordancer	Lextutor	
Monolingual Dictionaries	Collins Wiktionary Google Dictionary	Oxford Cambridge

Search Engine	Google Yahoo Bing Bing	AOL Baidu
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2. ICT Online Tools Improve Students' Academic Writing

Students' academic writing improved as a result of comparing their writing before and after using ICT online resources for writing education. Students' writing before and after using ICT online resources was compared using descriptive statistics to assess improvement. Before employing ICT online tools, students' writing was found to be inadequate since there were more pupils at the "good" writing proficiency level than at the "very good" level.

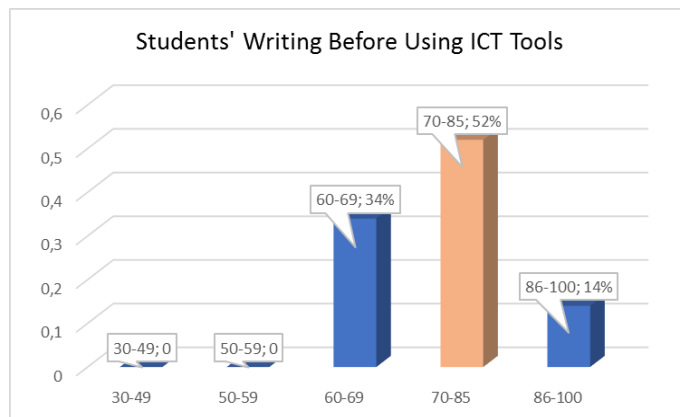


Figure 3. Students' Academic Writing of TBI A before Using ICT Online Tools

The accompanying figure shows TBI A's academic writing prior to the development of ICT online tools. While many students had strong academic writing

skills, just 14% had very high writing skills. About 34 percent of the class as a whole were moderate students. In the meantime, their writing improved in the following ways following the usage of ICT online resources to teach academic writing:

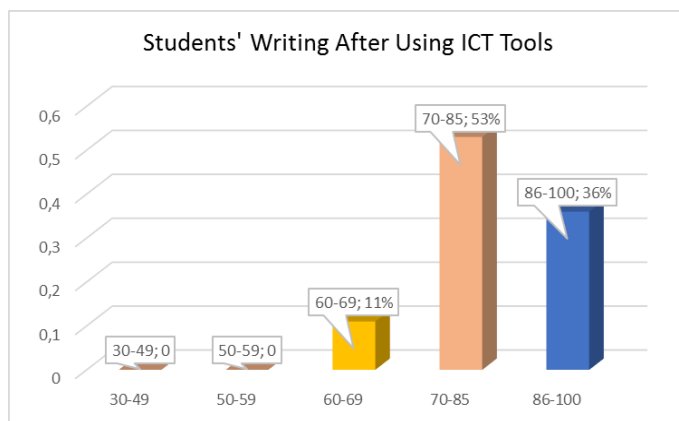


Figure 4. Students' Academic Writing of TBI A after Using ICT Online Tools

The image demonstrates that when ICT web resources are used to educate writing, students' academic writing improves. Students at a moderate level achieved 11% more than they did before the use of ICT. The proportion of students at a moderate level dropped by almost 25%. ICT web tools were used to teach writing, and the 'very excellent' quality of academic writing improved by 57%, with 36% of students reaching the very good level. In contrast to the statistics before the usage of ICT online tools, the 'good' level dropped to 10%.

Before the adoption of ICT tools to teach academic writing, the second class (TBI 5B) had unsatisfactory

writing results since none of the students were at the "very good" level, although 63% of the students were at the "good" level.

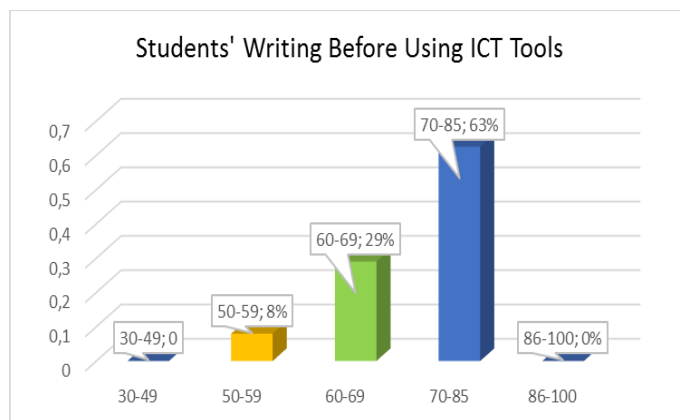


Figure 5. Students' Academic Writing of TBI B before Using ICT Online Tools

Eight percent received a D (bad writing), meaning their score fell between 50 and 59. Another 29 percent, or around seven kids, received a "moderate" level, or roughly 29 percent of the students.

Students' writing improved with positive outcomes with the use of ICT online resources to teach academic writing to class TBI B.

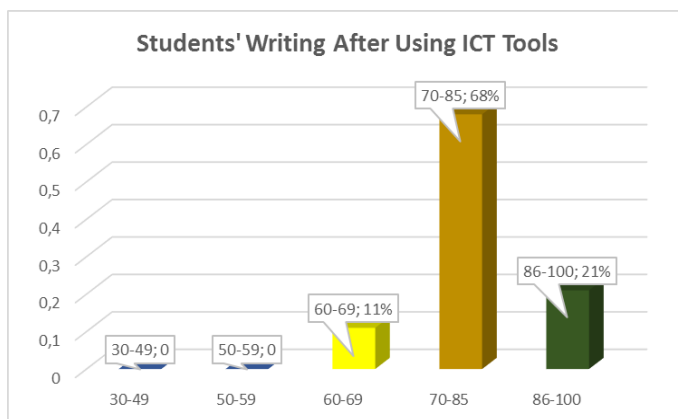


Figure 6. Students' Academic Writing of TBI B after Using ICT Online Tools

When ICT online tools were employed, the percentage of people with bad writing improved from 8% to 0%. significantly, going from 29% to 11%, indicating a 71% increase in students' academic writing skills. The 'very good' level improved by 100%, going from none of the students earning an A (very good) to 21%.

Furthermore, TBI C shown a significant improvement after using online ICT tools for academic writing. None of the students got an A or were at a very good level, while 45% of students wrote at a moderate level prior to the advent of ICT and online resources.

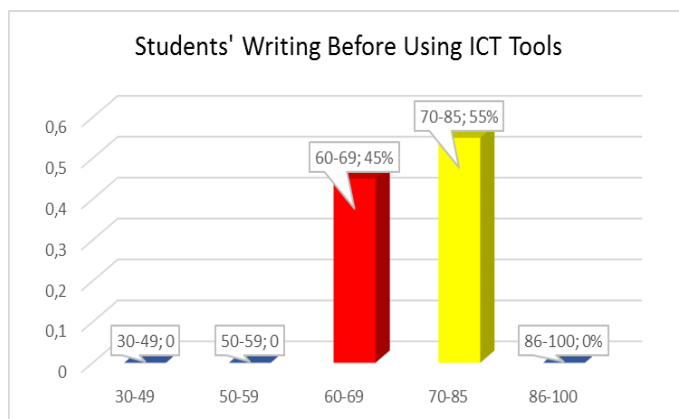


Figure 7. Students' Academic Writing of TBI C before Using ICT Online Tools

Fifty-five percent of the students had strong academic writing skills. Although none of the students had subpar writing skills, the main issue was that several of them had decent to moderate writing skills, while none of them had really good ones. Thus, it was necessary to decide to employ online ICT tools to enhance academic writing.

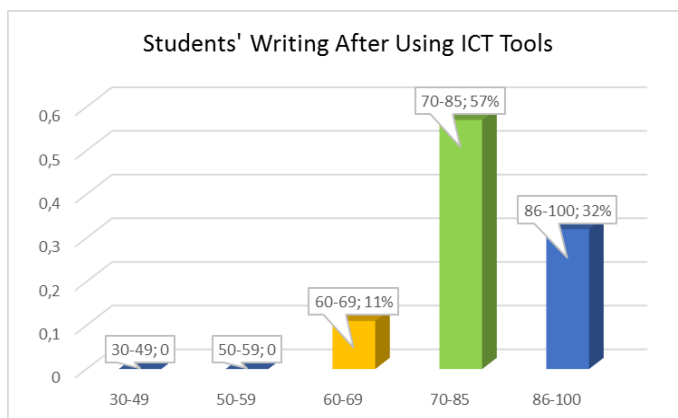


Figure 8. Students' Academic Writing of TBI C after Using ICT Online Tools

After employing ICT online tools to teach academic writing, students' academic writing produced good results. from the sixth graphic. The number of students at a moderate level has dropped from 45% (9 students) to 11% (2 students), a loss of around 78%. In the meantime, the percentage of students performing at a very excellent level rose from 0% to 32% (6 students). Before utilizing ICT online resources, 11 students, or 55% of the student body, had strong academic writing skills; after using ICT online tools, that number dropped to 57%.

The analysis of the students' artifacts revealed a noticeable improvement in the caliber of academic writing that the students were producing. The following table provides a summary of the results.

Table 2
Qualitative Analysis of Students' Artifacts

TRAIT	Before Using ICT Tools	After Using ICT Tools
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Logic & Organization	Lacks coherence, has an uneven and inefficient structure overall, and has an ambiguous opening and finish.	Rationally arranges ideas in paragraphs, links them with seamless transitions, and develops ideas coherently. An introduction and conclusion that are precise and unambiguous.
Language	Uses imprecise language, phrase construction that isn't obvious, and extremely distracting mistakes.	Uses language fluently, creates succinct phrases in normal English, and skillfully blends a range of sentence forms.
Spelling and Grammar	There are many spelling and grammatical mistakes in writing, which hinder understanding.	The material has been thoroughly vetted by the reader and adheres to standard spelling and grammatical rules, notwithstanding the possibility of a few small mistakes.
Development of Ideas	The logic is weak, the majority of concepts lack proof, and there is a mix-up between personal and external evidence.	Draws important differences and provides strong examples, references, and facts to back up the majority of views.
Purpose	The reader cannot clearly understand	To accomplish the writing's goal, the author has made wise

	the writing's goal or focus.	choices regarding structure, style, substance, and concentration.
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An examination of the students' scholarly writing revealed that prior to utilizing the resources provided by ICT, they were unable to arrange and rationally create thoughts. There were inconsistencies and inefficiencies in the text's organization. Both the students' introductions and conclusions lacked clarity. The following traits of their writing could be characterized: (1) some attempts at structure and order, even though there were still issues; (2) clear paragraphing; (3) attempts at idea sequencing and transitions; and (4) some development of the introduction and conclusion. The quality of students' academic writing significantly improved once they began using ICT tools to compose academic documents. With generally adequate transitions, a clear overall structure that connected most of the ideas, and a respectable introduction and conclusion, students were able to develop coherent and unified notions within paragraphs.

After using ICT tools in their academic writing, students were able to write more fluidly, construct succinct sentences in Standard English, and effectively balance a variety of sentence patterns. Each phrase has a strong and efficient structure. It would be advantageous for them to employ a broad range of carefully chosen sentence lengths and patterns.

According to the analysis's findings, before students began using ICT tools, their work was riddled with spelling and grammatical errors that made it

difficult to understand. Nonetheless, the results showed that academic writing's spelling and grammar were enhanced by the use of ICT. Even if there may have been a few errors, you can be confident that every piece of content was carefully checked and followed accepted spelling and grammatical guidelines.

The use of ICT online resources showed that students might enhance their textual development of ideas. The accompanying data was suitable for the audience and goal. Information from outside sources was combined and added to the text. They were able to provide compelling arguments, and their logic was sound. Additionally, the writing's subjects showed that the student was becoming more knowledgeable about the disciplines, genre's questions, values, and techniques.

The writing that students created after utilizing ICT resources demonstrated that, in terms of the writing's goal, they had effectively accomplished it by making wise choices about content, structure, style, and emphasis.

B. Discussion

Although students may not be accustomed to using ICT online resources for academic writing, the results of their academic writing after doing so demonstrate the influence of this practice. The outcomes of the students' academic writing projects showed that they had experimented with a novel approach to writing instruction using digital tools and that the learning environment for academic writing was more engaging. It is in line with Miller et al. (2005), who said that ICT has assisted teachers in finding innovative and engaging ways to use technology in the classroom. Utilizing digital

technology in the teaching-learning process can benefit students' learning outcomes and development, as it is commonly employed in education.

According to the interview and questionnaire results, students benefit from the abundance of ICT-based online resources while writing academically. When writing academic papers, students needed to use ICT and online research resources. To succeed, students must improve their writing abilities. Thus, it should come as no surprise that students are now using editing tools more than any other internet tool. With the use of editing tools, students could check their grammar and reword the paragraphs they had written. Students believed that using different types of text editing improved the overall caliber of their writing. Another resource that significantly influenced the literature that students wrote was translation tools. They are useful for students who need to translate content from English into their native language or vice versa. By employing the tools at their disposal, students may be able to deal with their vocabulary deficit more effectively. The information extracted from the students' artifacts also showed that using the ICT Online tools directly improved the students' writing abilities. Students used the web resources to build their ideas rationally. They used a logical framework to divide it up into paragraphs, and they used effective transitions to link each paragraph to the one before it. They were successful in crafting comprehensible and precise introductions and conclusions. With internet tools, students were able to utilize language more smoothly. They were able to produce clear, succinct phrases in Standard English that appropriately balanced a range of sentence structures.

With the use of internet resources, students were also able to provide solid examples, references, and facts to back up most of the ideas they wrote about.

CHAPTER 5: CONCLUSION AND SUGGESTIONS

A. Conclusion

The following is a description of the current study's findings. This investigation allows for the drawing of two conclusions. First, when it comes to the employment of ICT online tools in academic writing, it was discovered that these students employed a variety of online resources to enhance the caliber of their work. Internet resources were selected because of their usefulness in the process of creating scholarly material. The students utilized a variety of resources, including search engines, citation tools, editing tools, translation tools, bilingual and monolingual dictionaries, and a bilingual concordancer.

Second, this research found that students gain from academic writing resources online in a number of ways, particularly when it comes to using ICT online tools to improve the quality of their academic writing. Students were able to preserve appropriate language and sentence structure by using editing tools. The translation tool was another useful resource that encouraged students to increase their vocabulary in order to effectively communicate in a variety of contexts and registers. Students can use search engines independently to discover more. They may discover evidence to back up their writing. In summary, students' writing quality increased as a result of using digital resources.

B. Suggestions for Further Researchers

As a direct result of this, more academics are expected to conduct scientific studies on the two factors listed above. Additionally, by examining the interaction of growth mindset, metacognition, and learning engagement as the predicted elements influencing the effectiveness of ICT online tools, researchers may do a psychometric study to create a theoretical model. A theoretical model can be developed in this way. The use of scaffolding by English instructors to support their students' growth mindsets, metacognition, and learner engagement during ICT-based learning might be the subject of future studies.

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